GRADE 8 CHRISTIAN RELIGIOUS EDUCATION (CRE)

DETAILED TEACHING NOTES – FULL YEAR 2027

School: _____ **Teacher:** _____ **TSC No.:** _____

Grade: 8 | **Learning Area:** Christian Religious Education | **Suggested lessons:** 120

Curriculum note: These teacher-prepared notes follow the Grade 8 CRE strand and sub-strand sequence used in the accompanying scheme. They are explanatory support materials, not a verbatim reproduction of the complete KICD curriculum design. Teachers should cross-check the official design and the Bible translation used by their institution before teaching.

How to use: Begin with the Bible passage, guide learners to observe and interpret the text, connect the teaching to age-appropriate situations, and assess through discussion, written work, role-play, reflection and practical application. Avoid forcing learners to disclose private family or personal experiences.

CORE CHRISTIAN EDUCATION APPROACH

CRE supports learners to understand biblical teachings, develop Christian values and make responsible decisions in everyday life. Teaching should be participatory, inclusive, respectful of different backgrounds and attentive to learner safeguarding. Use scripture accurately, allow questions, and distinguish the biblical account from personal opinion.

YEAR OVERVIEW

Strand	Sub-strands	Suggested lessons
1.0 Creation	1.1 Origin and Consequences of Sin; 1.2 God's Plan for Redemption	12
2.0 The Bible: Selected Teachings	2.1 Faith and God's Promises; 2.2 Abrahamic Covenant; 2.3 Leadership in Israel (Saul)	18
3.0 The Life and Ministry of Jesus Christ	3.1 Healing of Blind Bartimaeus; 3.2 Calming the Storm; 3.3 Healing of the Paralytic	21
4.0 Teachings of Jesus Christ	4.1 Teaching on Prayer; 4.2 The Lost Sheep	14
5.0 The Church	5.1 The Holy Spirit; 5.2 Acts of Compassion	14
6.0 Christian Living Today	6.1 Family Relationships; 6.2 Human Sexuality: Responsible Sexual Behaviour; 6.3 Sacredness of Life; 6.4 Bullying; 6.5 Work: Talents and Abilities; 6.6 Leisure	41
TOTAL		120

1.1 Origin and Consequences of Sin

Key Bible references: Genesis 1–4; Genesis 11:1–9; 1 John 1:9

Teaching overview

Sin refers to thoughts, attitudes or actions that go against God's will. The creation and fall narratives show human beings choosing disobedience and experiencing broken relationships with God, one another and creation.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read Genesis 3:1–13 and identify the choices made by the characters.

• Discuss the consequences described in Genesis 3:14–19 and 3:23.

• Read Genesis 4:6–12 and 11:1–9 to examine how wrongdoing affected relationships and communities.

• Identify age-appropriate pressures that may lead young people to make harmful choices.

• Explore repentance, confession, seeking forgiveness and making amends.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain the origin of sin in the biblical account.

• Identify consequences of sin for individuals and relationships.

• Suggest values and life skills that help resist temptation.

Key vocabulary

Temptation, disobedience, responsibility, consequences, repentance, forgiveness, self-control.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Ask learners to sequence the events in Genesis 3; assess their explanation of consequences and their suggested responses to peer pressure.

Teacher reflection:

_____

1.2 God's Plan for Redemption

Key Bible references: Genesis 3:15; John 3:16; Romans 5:8; Ephesians 1:7; 1 John 1:9

Teaching overview

Redemption is God's saving work to restore people from sin. Christian teaching presents God as continuing to love humankind after the fall and providing salvation through Jesus Christ.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Discuss why human beings need redemption in the context of the fall.

• Read selected passages and identify what they reveal about God's love and saving purpose.

• Explain the Christian belief that Jesus Christ is central to salvation.

• Discuss repentance, forgiveness and reconciliation as responses to God's grace.

• Relate redemption to choices that restore trust and relationships.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain the meaning of redemption.

• Describe ways the Bible presents God's love and plan for salvation.

• Relate repentance and forgiveness to daily relationships.

Key vocabulary

Redemption, salvation, grace, repentance, forgiveness, reconciliation.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Use a scripture-based concept map and a short reflection on how forgiveness can restore relationships.

Teacher reflection:

2.1 Faith and God’s Promises

Key Bible references: Genesis 12:1–9; Genesis 15:1–6; Hebrews 11:1–12

Teaching overview

Faith involves trust and confidence in God. Biblical accounts show people responding to God’s promises even when the outcome is not immediately visible. Abraham is a key example of trust and obedience.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Clarify the meaning of faith and promise.

• Read the accounts of Abraham and identify the promises made by God.

• Discuss Abraham’s response and the challenges involved in trusting a promise.

• Identify examples of faithfulness and trust in the Bible.

• Consider practical ways to show trust, patience and integrity.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain faith and promise using biblical examples.

• Identify promises made by God in selected passages.

• Discuss how faith can influence decisions.

Key vocabulary

Faith, trust, promise, obedience, patience, hope.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess learners’ ability to cite a biblical example and explain a lesson about trust.

Teacher reflection:

2.2 Abrahamic Covenant

Key Bible references: Genesis 12:1–3; Genesis 15; Genesis 17:1–8

Teaching overview

A covenant is a solemn agreement or commitment. In the biblical account, God makes promises to Abraham concerning descendants, land and blessing. Abraham responds through faith and obedience.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read the relevant passages and identify the promises in each account.

• Discuss Abraham’s response to God’s instructions.

• Explain the significance of covenant as a relationship based on commitment.

• Identify lessons on faith, obedience and responsibility.

• Connect the ideas to keeping promises and commitments.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain the meaning of covenant.

• Describe promises made to Abraham.

• Derive lessons on faith and obedience.

Key vocabulary

Covenant, promise, descendants, blessing, obedience, commitment.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Learners complete a promise-and-response chart based on the passages and explain two lessons.

Teacher reflection:

_____

2.3 Leadership in Israel (Saul)

Key Bible references: 1 Samuel 8:4–22; 1 Samuel 9–10; 1 Samuel 13; 1 Samuel 15

Teaching overview

Saul was selected and anointed as the first king of Israel. His story offers examples of leadership responsibility, achievements, disobedience and the consequences of decisions.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read the account of Israel asking for a king and discuss the context.

• Trace Saul's selection and anointing.

• Identify positive leadership qualities and responsibilities.

• Examine episodes in which Saul disobeyed instructions and discuss consequences.

• Relate the lessons to responsible leadership in school and community.

Expected learning outcomes

• Describe Saul's appointment as king.

• Examine examples of Saul's leadership decisions.

• Identify qualities of responsible leadership.

Key vocabulary

Leadership, accountability, obedience, integrity, service, responsibility.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Use a leadership strengths-and-challenges table and a short written response on responsible leadership.

Teacher reflection:

_____

3.1 Healing of Blind Bartimaeus

Key Bible references: Mark 10:46–52; Luke 18:35–43

Teaching overview

The account describes Bartimaeus calling out to Jesus despite attempts to silence him. Jesus responds, and Bartimaeus receives his sight. The narrative highlights faith, persistence, compassion and inclusion.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read Mark 10:46–52 and identify the people and events.

• Discuss Bartimaeus' persistence and the response of the crowd.

• Examine Jesus' question and response to Bartimaeus.

• Identify lessons about listening to people, dignity and inclusion.

• Present the account through a respectful role-play or story sequence.

Expected learning outcomes

• Retell the healing of Bartimaeus.

• Interpret lessons on faith and compassion.

• Suggest ways to include and support people with disabilities.

Key vocabulary

Faith, persistence, compassion, dignity, inclusion, healing.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess the event sequence, scripture interpretation and practical inclusion suggestions.

Teacher reflection:

_____

3.2 Calming the Storm

Key Bible references: Mark 4:35–41; Matthew 8:23–27; Luke 8:22–25

Teaching overview

Jesus and the disciples cross a lake when a storm arises. The disciples become afraid, Jesus calms the storm and challenges them to consider their faith. The account explores fear, trust and Jesus' authority.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read one Gospel account and sequence the events.

• Identify the disciples' reaction and Jesus' response.

• Discuss fear and trust without dismissing genuine feelings.

• Explore how prayer, calm thinking and seeking help can support people during challenges.

• Present lessons from the account.

Expected learning outcomes

• Describe the miracle of calming the storm.

• Explain lessons about faith and trust.

• Identify healthy responses when facing difficulties.

Key vocabulary

Fear, faith, trust, courage, prayer, reassurance.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Use oral questioning and an exit ticket asking learners to state one lesson and one practical response to fear.

Teacher reflection:

_____

3.3 Healing of the Paralytic

Key Bible references: Mark 2:1–12; Matthew 9:1–8; Luke 5:17–26

Teaching overview

Friends bring a paralysed man to Jesus, demonstrating determination and care. Jesus speaks of forgiveness and heals the man. The account highlights faith, friendship, compassion and restoration.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read the account and identify the actions of the paralysed man's friends.

• Discuss how the friends overcame obstacles to reach Jesus.

• Examine the connection between forgiveness and healing in the narrative.

• Identify lessons about friendship and supporting people with disabilities or illness.

• Create a sequence chart or role-play.

Expected learning outcomes

• Retell the healing of the paralytic.

• Explain the role of the friends in the account.

• Apply lessons on faith, friendship and compassion.

Key vocabulary

Friendship, faith, compassion, forgiveness, healing, support.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess a sequence chart and learners' explanation of how to support others respectfully.

Teacher reflection:

4.1 Teaching on Prayer

Key Bible references: Matthew 6:5–15; Luke 11:1–4; Matthew 7:7–11

Teaching overview

Jesus teaches that prayer should be sincere and directed to God rather than performed to impress others. The Lord's Prayer provides a model that includes honouring God, seeking daily needs, forgiveness and guidance.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read Matthew 6:5–15 and identify Jesus' guidance about prayer.

• Examine the parts of the Lord's Prayer and discuss their meaning.

• Compare sincere prayer with prayer intended to attract attention.

• Discuss different situations in which Christians pray.

• Compose a short prayer using respectful language.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain Jesus' teaching on prayer.

• Interpret key parts of the Lord's Prayer.

• Demonstrate respectful participation in prayer.

Key vocabulary

Prayer, sincerity, forgiveness, gratitude, dependence, guidance.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Learners annotate the Lord's Prayer and write a brief explanation of two sections.

Teacher reflection:

4.2 The Lost Sheep

Key Bible references: Luke 15:1–7; Matthew 18:10–14

Teaching overview

Jesus uses the parable of a shepherd searching for one lost sheep to illustrate God's concern for those who are lost. The story teaches care, value, repentance and restoration.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read and retell the parable in sequence.

• Discuss why the shepherd searches for the one lost sheep.

• Interpret the joy associated with finding what was lost.

• Relate the story to including people who feel isolated or excluded.

• Suggest practical ways of showing concern for others.

Expected learning outcomes

• Narrate the parable of the Lost Sheep.

• Interpret its teaching about God's care.

• Demonstrate concern for others.

Key vocabulary

Parable, shepherd, care, value, repentance, restoration.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess a story map and learners' proposed acts of inclusion and care.

Teacher reflection:

5.1 The Holy Spirit

Key Bible references: John 14:15–17, 25–26; Acts 2:1–13; Galatians 5:22–23; 1 Corinthians 12:4–11

Teaching overview

Christian teaching describes the Holy Spirit as God's presence and guide in the life of believers. Biblical passages discuss guidance, gifts for service and qualities associated with the Spirit.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read selected passages and identify what they teach about the Holy Spirit.

• Discuss how guidance and encouragement are described in scripture.

• Explore gifts and abilities that can be used to serve others.

• Study the fruit of the Spirit in Galatians 5:22–23.

• Identify practical ways to develop qualities such as love, patience and self-control.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain the role of the Holy Spirit in Christian life.

• Identify gifts and qualities discussed in scripture.

• Suggest ways to use abilities in service to others.

Key vocabulary

Holy Spirit, guidance, gifts, service, fruit of the Spirit, self-control.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Use a scripture evidence chart and a personal goal related to one quality.

Teacher reflection:

5.2 Acts of Compassion

Key Bible references: Luke 10:25–37; Matthew 25:31–40; James 2:14–17

Teaching overview

Compassion involves noticing suffering and responding with care. Biblical examples, including the Good Samaritan, show that love of neighbour is demonstrated through practical help.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Read the parable of the Good Samaritan and identify the actions of each character.

• Discuss what made the Samaritan's response compassionate.

• Identify needs in the local community without exposing private information.

• Plan a safe, appropriate class service activity with adult approval.

• Reflect on the effect of practical help.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain compassion using a biblical example.

• Identify ways of helping people in need.

• Participate in an appropriate act of service.

Key vocabulary

Compassion, neighbour, service, empathy, generosity, safeguarding.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess group planning, participation and reflection. Ensure visits, donations and contact with vulnerable people are authorised and safeguarded.

Teacher reflection:

_____

6.1 Family Relationships

Key Bible references: Exodus 20:12; Ephesians 6:1–4; Colossians 3:20–21

Teaching overview

Families may take different forms. Christian teachings emphasise respect, care, responsibility and love among family members. Healthy relationships involve communication, cooperation and resolving disagreements peacefully.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Discuss different roles and responsibilities within families without assuming all learners have the same family structure.

• Read the selected passages and identify guidance for family relationships.

• Explore causes of disagreements and peaceful ways of resolving them.

• Practise respectful communication through scenarios.

• Identify trusted adults who can support a learner experiencing harm.

Expected learning outcomes

• Outline responsibilities within family relationships.

• Identify practices that promote healthy relationships.

• Suggest peaceful ways of resolving conflict.

Key vocabulary

Family, respect, responsibility, communication, cooperation, reconciliation.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess scenario responses and a short reflection on respectful communication.

Teacher reflection:

_____

6.2 Human Sexuality: Responsible Sexual Behaviour

Key Bible references: 1 Thessalonians 4:3–6; Romans 12:1–2; 1 Corinthians 6:18–20

Teaching overview

This sub-strand addresses personal dignity, safety, responsible behaviour and values. Teaching must be age-appropriate, factual, non-stigmatising and consistent with child safeguarding requirements.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Establish respectful ground rules and clarify that learners need not disclose personal experiences.

• Discuss personal boundaries, consent, safety and forms of abuse in age-appropriate terms.

• Identify trusted adults and safe reporting/help-seeking channels.

• Explore peer pressure, assertiveness and decision-making skills.

• Discuss the curriculum's Christian teaching on responsible behaviour and self-respect.

Expected learning outcomes

• Identify forms of abuse and safe ways of seeking help.

• Discuss consequences of irresponsible sexual behaviour using age-appropriate information.

• Demonstrate assertive ways to resist harmful pressure and seek support.

Key vocabulary

Dignity, personal safety, boundaries, assertiveness, responsibility, trusted support.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Use anonymous scenario cards and check understanding of safe help-seeking. Never ask learners to reveal personal sexual experiences.

Teacher reflection:

_____

6.3 Sacredness of Life

Key Bible references: Genesis 1:26–27; Genesis 4:10–11; Genesis 9:6; Exodus 20:13

Teaching overview

The biblical idea of the sacredness of life affirms human dignity and the value of every person. The sub-strand considers threats to life and the responsibility to protect and support others.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Discuss the meaning of human dignity and the value of life.

• Read selected passages and identify biblical reasons for respecting life.

• Explore ways the right to life may be violated and how communities can protect people.

• Discuss emotional distress and the importance of reaching trusted adults and qualified support.

• Handle sensitive curriculum themes respectfully, without graphic detail or stigma.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain the sacredness of life.

• Identify ways human life and dignity may be threatened.

• Suggest actions that protect life and support people at risk.

Key vocabulary

Dignity, sacredness of life, protection, empathy, support, responsibility.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess learners' understanding through a protective-actions poster and scenario discussion. If a learner indicates immediate risk of self-harm or harm, follow school safeguarding procedures and seek qualified help promptly.

Teacher reflection:

_____

6.4 Bullying

Key Bible references: Matthew 5:11–12; Romans 12:18–20; 1 John 3:15

Teaching overview

Bullying is repeated harmful behaviour involving a real or perceived imbalance of power. It may be physical, verbal, social or online. Christian values support dignity, love, respect and peaceful coexistence.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Define bullying and distinguish it from an isolated disagreement.

• Identify forms and possible effects of bullying.

• Discuss safe ways to report bullying and support affected learners.

• Read the selected passages and identify teachings about peaceful relationships.

• Develop a class message promoting respect and inclusion.

Expected learning outcomes

• Identify forms and causes of bullying.

• Analyse effects of bullying on individuals and families.

• Demonstrate ways of promoting peaceful coexistence and seeking help.

Key vocabulary

Bullying, dignity, respect, inclusion, peaceful coexistence, reporting.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess case-study responses and a class anti-bullying message. Do not require public disclosure of incidents.

Teacher reflection:

_____

6.5 Work: Talents and Abilities

Key Bible references: Matthew 25:14–30; Romans 12:4–8; 1 Peter 4:10

Teaching overview

The parable of the talents encourages responsible use of what has been entrusted to people. Learners can identify abilities, practise them and use them constructively to serve others and contribute to their communities.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Discuss the meaning of talents, abilities and gifts.

• Read the parable of the talents and examine the different responses of the servants.

• Identify personal strengths through positive, inclusive activities.

• Plan a simple, safe and age-appropriate enterprise or service idea.

• Discuss honesty, teamwork, responsibility and wise use of resources.

Expected learning outcomes

• Identify personal talents and abilities.

• Apply lessons from the parable of the talents.

• Develop a simple idea for using a talent productively.

Key vocabulary

Talent, ability, stewardship, responsibility, initiative, service.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess a talent inventory and a simple enterprise/service plan. Avoid financial risk or unsafe commercial activity.

Teacher reflection:

_____

6.6 Leisure

Key Bible references: Exodus 20:8–11; 1 Corinthians 10:23, 31; Philippians 4:8

Teaching overview

Leisure is time available for rest and constructive activities outside required work. Christian teaching encourages choices that are beneficial, responsible and respectful of self and others.

Suggested teaching and learning sequence

• Discuss what leisure means and list constructive activities learners enjoy.

• Identify reasons young people may misuse free time.

• Examine possible effects of harmful leisure choices.

• Read the selected passages and identify principles for making wise choices.

• Prepare a balanced plan for study, rest, recreation, family and community activities.

Expected learning outcomes

• Explain the meaning of leisure.

• Identify consequences of misusing leisure time.

• Prepare a plan for constructive use of free time.

Key vocabulary

Leisure, recreation, balance, responsibility, self-management, wise choices.

Assessment and evidence of learning

Assess a weekly leisure plan and learners' explanation of how their choices promote wellbeing and responsibility.

Teacher reflection:

_____